



also to the heavy immigration of other Europeans in the late 19th and 20th centuries. Today, these settlers have almost swamped the indigenous peoples: the prevailing culture in Argentina is Hispanic,

Spanish is the national language, and Roman Catholicism is the dominant religion. Nearly 90 percent of the population live in cities, and more than one-third are in or near the capital, Buenos Aires.



GATHERING GRAPES

The heart of Argentina's prosperous wine industry is the western province of Mendoza. The country's first vines were planted in this area in order to provide communion wine to colonists from Chile. Here, local grape pickers bring in another year's harvest.



OFF THE HOOF

The production of beef (in the form of both cattle and meatpacking industries), dominates Argentina's economy. Because of this, the *asado*, or barbecue—always a male domain—is an important social ritual. Locals tend to prefer their roasts and steaks well cooked.

ROMANCE OF THE RANGE

Cattle ranching is centered in the flat, fertile, farmland region known as the Pampa. Historically, the work is done by nomadic horsemen called *gauchos*, whose almost mythical status parallels that of the American cowboy. Bucking tradition, these Hereford cows are being herded by a lady *gaucho*, or *gaucha*.

